



Maintain contacts with handling agents

D2.TTG.CL3.12

Assessor Manual



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Project Base

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Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

Suggested Assessment Methods

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

Alternative Assessment Methods

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

Selection of Assessment Methods

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

Assessing Competency

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

Pass Competent (PC)

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

Not Yet Competent' (NYC)

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region.

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

Code of Practice for Assessors

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

Instructions and Checklist for Assessors

Instructions

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

Preparation

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

Briefing Checklist

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

Checklist for Assessors

Prior to the assessment I have:	Tick (✓)	Remarks
Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.		
Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP).		
Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.		
Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.		
Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.		
During the assessment I have:		
Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.		
Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.		
Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.		
Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.		
Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.		
Explained the results reporting procedure.		
Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.		
Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.		
Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.		
After the assessment I have:		
Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.		
Completed and signed the assessment record.		
Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.		

Instructions for Recording Competency

Specifications for Recording Competency

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

Instructions for Different Assessment Methods

Specifications for Work Project Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
 - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
 - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
 - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
 - At 'X' location*
 - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
 - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
 - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
 - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
 - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
 - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Oral Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
 - Enter Student name
 - Enter Assessor name
 - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):
"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.

We have 60 minutes for this assessment.

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
 - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
 - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
 - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
 - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Written Question Assessment

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

Specifications for Observation Checklist

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

Specifications for Third Party Statement

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
 - Pass Competent = Yes
 - Not Yet Competent = No
 - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.

Competency standard

UNIT TITLE: MAINTAIN CONTACTS WITH HANDLING AGENTS		NOMINAL HOURS: 30
UNIT NUMBER: D2.TTG.CL3.12		
UNIT DESCRIPTOR: This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to maintain contacts with and obtain information from ground handling agents		
ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA		UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE
Element 1: Define the role of the handling agent 1.1 Identify the <i>organisations who use the services of handling agents</i> 1.2 Identify the <i>general services provided by handling agents</i> 1.3 Identify the <i>benefits of using handling agents</i> Element 2: Describe the contact and operational protocols between the business and the handling agent 2.1 Identify <i>key contact personnel</i> within the business providing handling agency services 2.2 Identify <i>contact details</i>		Unit Variables The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment This unit applies to all industry sectors that deal with overseas or remote businesses within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include: 1. Travel Agencies 2. Tour Operation <i>Organisations who use the services of handling agents</i> may be related to: • Airlines and other types of carriers • Travel agencies • Tour operators • Accommodation venues • Any business involved in the supply chain for travel and tourism products and services that uses the services of a handling agent, especially one in an international destination.

2.3 <i>Determine the time difference between the host enterprise country and the location of the handling agent</i> 2.4 <i>Identify the recognised holiday periods for the year in question for the country where the handling agent is situated</i> 2.5 <i>Identify the preferred protocols for contacting the handling agents</i> 2.6 <i>Create comprehensive list of services available from the handling agent</i> Element 3: Describe situations where contact with handling agents may be required 3.1 <i>Enquire about options for packages</i> 3.2 <i>Enquire about local conditions</i> 3.3 <i>Follow-up on customer issues</i> 3.4 <i>Update existing arrangements</i> 3.5 <i>Advise and confirm travel arrangements</i> 3.6 <i>Obtain specialist advice</i> Element 4: Evaluate the relationship with handling agents 4.1 <i>Record evidence of the service received from handling agents</i> 4.2 <i>Seek feedback from handling agents</i> 4.3 <i>Provide feedback to management regarding the service received</i>	<i>General services provided</i> will include: • Passenger service assistance • Check-in assistance • Baggage handling services • Arranging optional tours/activities available as part of a package • Facilitating transfers • Providing local information • Supplying local destination updates • Investigating local problems and issues affecting customers on behalf of the principal • Investigating local options and opportunities for the principal • Providing feedback to principal on the products and services being provided to the principal by third party providers/suppliers, such as accommodation venues, supplementary transport providers, attractions • Supplying detailed recommendations relating to targeted business/potential business opportunities and/or initiatives. <i>Benefits of using handling agents</i> may include: • Cost effectiveness, avoids having to establish and maintain an office in the country • Local knowledge, allows the organisation to have quick and constant access to local information from international countries • Language expertise, provides an on-the-ground person who can speak the local language • Local networks, provides a ready-made source of industry-related contacts that can facilitate access to identified products and services
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4.4 <i>Recommend action</i> to improve the relationship with handling agents	- Local experience, allows the user to benefit from local knowledge about the reputation, expertise, experience, nature, quality and environment/ambience of local venues, attractions, destinations and providers. <i>Key contact personnel</i> may include and/or relate to: - The business operator; some handling agents may be sole traders - Names of individuals - Positions of staff within the organisation - Details of roles and responsibilities of individuals as assigned by the handling agency - Reading employee biographies, as supplied on the internet - Visiting the handling agency and meeting individual handling agency personnel. <i>Contact details</i> must include an exhaustive list of contact information that will enable contact 24-hours a day if required and may include: - Street address - Postal address - Telephone numbers, including international direct dial (IDD) codes and country codes as appropriate for: - General reception/office landline number - Direct landline numbers for all nominated agency staff the organisation has identified as being relevant/useful to their operation - Mobile telephone numbers for all nominated agency staff the organisation has identified as being relevant/useful to their operation - Specific after hours contact details, including for contact after normal business hours in the country where the handling agency is situated
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	• Facsimile number(s) • E-mail addresses for all nominated agency staff the organisation has identified as being relevant/useful to their operation • Website addresses • Telex number(s). <i>Determine the time difference</i> may include: • Generating a table showing the relative times in the host country and the country of the handling agent for a 24-hour period <i>Recognised holiday periods</i> must include: • Holiday seasons • Specific days • Religious festivals • Local events, including sporting events. <i>Preferred protocols</i> are intended to facilitate communication and optimise the provision of required information between the host enterprise and the handling agent and may include: • Determining the nature of the information that needs to be obtained before making contact, understanding that the person who needs to be contacted may vary depending on the nature of the enquiry to be made • Recording the preferences for individual handling agency staff personnel in relation to: ▪ Time of day, such as AM or PM ▪ Method of contact, including verbal, written/printed or electronic • Scheduling regular contact times to facilitate the exchange of information and maintain communication channels even where no specific information is required
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	• Accommodating handling agency protocols in relation to payment for services rendered which may include pre-payment, approved authorisations/orders for work and recording details of time spent on the telephone answering queries/responding to host enterprise requirements • Determining the parameters of work that the handling agent is required to provide in relation to arrangements and agreements that exist • Establishing operational understanding that new work, information, research and similar required by the host enterprise will be remunerated appropriately despite the absence of a relevant existing contractual relationship, underlining the need for the handling agent to take immediate action on an issue safe in the knowledge that payment will be made for such services. <i>Create comprehensive list of services available may include:</i> • Obtaining same from handling agents • Accessing websites • Generating a list that accommodates needs specific to the host enterprise • Including all contact details and staff names. <i>Enquire about options for packages may include:</i> • Seeking input for the development of new packages, including information regarding local destinations, events, attractions and costs • Seeking alternatives to enable existing packages to be modified on the basis of customer feedback, customer preferences, or to revise an existing package • Seeking information regarding optional tours, sightseeing, activities that can be provided within a package • Seeking market place information regarding the activities of local travel and tour operators
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	• Seeking contextual information and identified specific data to enable the accurate and effective development of promotional material and selling activities • Arranging monitoring activities and feedback protocols for inclusions in packages. <i>Enquire about local conditions</i> may initially involve development information, then updating information throughout the life of a package and may include: • Seeking initial information and updates relating to: ▪ Weather ▪ Currency ▪ The economy ▪ Availability of products and services ▪ Political stability ▪ Industry position, including actual and potential changes to that position ▪ Service delivery, including services available and changes to services ▪ Procedural and processing matters, including loading, disembarkation and arrival procedures ▪ Health-related and safety issues ▪ Special needs passengers and children ▪ Social, cultural and environmental issues ▪ Schedules and timetables ▪ General availability of products and services ▪ Local requirements relating to tour and travel arrangements, including changes to legislated requirements ▪ Cost and prices, including fees and charges ▪ Geographical layout of areas, buildings and facilities, including airports and terminals
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	▪ Trading hours of businesses ▪ Local assistance available to travellers and tourists • Seeking information and advice in relation to circumstances that arise, including emergency situations that have the potential to impact on existing travel arrangements. <i>Follow-up on customer issues</i> may include: • Responding to specific customer enquiries • Seeking action and assistance in response to requested last minute changes to customer itinerary • Seeking baggage handling assistance, including luggage transfers and lost baggage • Requesting contact with travellers in response to an emergency situation, including family matters, legal issues and property-related emergencies • Arranging independent evaluation of activities, destinations and venues as a result of negative customer feedback received. <i>Update existing arrangements</i> may include: • Seeking advice in relation to proposed changes involving the country where the handling agent is located • Notifying handling agent of changes that have been made to travel arrangements for individual passengers/customers • Notifying handling agent in relation to generic changes that have been implemented to packages including revisions to inclusions and options, changes to times and destinations, alterations to costs, amendments to delivery standards and services.
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	<i>Advise and confirm travel arrangements</i> may include: • Notifying handling agents of passenger manifests • Notifying handling agents of package details, including inclusions and options • Confirming previously advised travel details, including times, carriers, flight numbers, passenger numbers and details • Advising handling agents of changes to previously notified travel arrangements • Notifying handling agents in relation to problems and issues experienced prior to departure of passengers from the host country, including passport and visa issues, delays to departures, passenger illness, changes to names of travellers and problem passengers. <i>Obtain specialist advice</i> may include: • Seeking contacts to enable the provision of relevant advice from a third party in the country of the handling agent • Engaging the handling agent to undertake specific extraordinary tasks on behalf of the host enterprise, including market research, mystery shopper activities, identifying potential joint venture partners and meeting with authorities and relevant government agencies on behalf of the host enterprise • Obtaining and/or clarifying information regarding processes, laws and customs that exist in the country of the handling agent. <i>Record evidence of the service received</i> may include: • Documenting details of requests made to handling agents and their responses, including: ▪ Speed of response ▪ Comprehensiveness, accuracy, reliability and usefulness of information provided ▪ Call back times
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	▪ Availability of key staff within the handling agent organisation, including out of hours availability • Willingness to be of assistance. <i>Seek feedback from handling agents may include:</i> • Requesting advice from individual handling agents, organisations and individual personnel, regarding their experience of working with the host enterprise • Seeking advice as to how the existing relationship can be maintained and improved. <i>Provide feedback to management may include:</i> • Providing verbal and/or written reports • Contextualising the feedback • Supplying supporting evidence of feedback provided. <i>Recommend action may include:</i> • Changing handling agents • Revising the contractual agreement that exists with the handling agents, including an extension of the existing parameters to include activities and information provision not previously covered • Altering the communication protocols that exist between parties • Seeking improved access to existing staff.
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	Assessment Guide The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit: • Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to the use of handling agents • Principles of written and verbal communication with people and organisations from overseas countries • Ability to use negotiation, questioning, liaison and research techniques • Knowledge of the time zones and telephone call protocols that apply to the countries where there is a handling agent relationship • Ability to use the communication tools and technologies required for communication with handling agents • Ability to foster and maintain an effective working relationship with organisations and individual staff. Linkages To Other Units • Access and retrieve computer-based data • Communicate on the telephone • Manage and resolve conflict situations • Receive and resolve customer complaints
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|--|---|
| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Work effectively with colleagues and customers• Work in a socially diverse environment• Establish and maintain a business relationship• Maintain quality customer/guest service• Plan and establish systems and procedures• Prepare business documents• Use common business tools and technology• Work cooperatively in a general administration environment• Develop and implement operational policies• Develop and update tourism industry knowledge• Promote products and services to customers• Access and interpret product information• Produce travel documentation on a computer• Construct and apply tourism product research• Create, implement and evaluate strategic product initiatives• Develop and monitor culturally appropriate tourism activity• Develop/monitor ecologically sustainable tourism operations• Develop and manage business strategies• Manage and monitor innovative tourism programs and projects• Manage contractual agreements/commitments. |
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	Critical Aspects of Assessment Evidence of the following is essential: • Understanding of host enterprise policies and procedures in regard to the use of handling agents • Demonstrated ability to produce a comprehensive, accurate and current database for at least one handling agent in each of three nominated overseas countries that identifies in each instance: ▪ Name of the handling agent ▪ Full range of services provided ▪ Cost(s) for services provided ▪ Full range of contact details and options, including out of hours details ▪ Comparative time chart for each agent/country relative to the host country ▪ Names, positions and where applicable, specialist roles and expertise of personnel within the handling agency ▪ Recognised holidays/holiday periods, including events and religious festivals, in the country where the handling agents is located ▪ Brief overview of the agency experience and history in providing handling agency services to travel and tourism businesses • Demonstrated ability to verbally communicate with a real or simulated handling agent representative and undertake at least ten contact activities which must include: ▪ Seeking nominated information on products and services available as possible inclusions ▪ Seeking nominated information on alternatives for trips/sight-seeing ▪ Advising on nominated changes to existing passenger/traveller arrangements ▪ Seeking action on nominated emergency issues
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- Seeking information on a nominated type of legal issue that tourists and travellers are required to comply with
- Resolving a nominated traveller/passenger problem.

Context of Assessment

This unit may be assessed on or off the job

- Assessment should include practical demonstration either in the workplace or through a simulation activity, supported by a range of methods to assess underpinning knowledge
- Assessment must relate to the individual's work area or area of responsibility.

Resource Implications

Training and assessment to include access to a real or simulated workplace; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment.

Assessment Methods

The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit:

- Observation of practical candidate performance
- Oral and written questions
- Problem solving
- Role plays involving communications with handling agents
- Third party reports completed by a supervisor
- Project and assignment work.

Key Competencies in this Unit

Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively

Level 2 = competence to manage tasks

Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating

	Key Competencies	Level	Examples
	Collecting, organising and analysing information	1	Obtain information regarding services available from handling agents
	Communicating ideas and information	2	Liaise with handling agents to amend existing arrangements
	Planning and organising activities	2	Schedule regular contact with handling agents
	Working with others and in teams	2	Communicate with handling agency personnel to gain required information and advice
	Using mathematical ideas and techniques	1	Determine time zone differences between host country and the country where the handling agents are located
	Solving problems	2	Resolve customer-related travel issues
	Using technology	1	Use telecommunications systems and the internet to communicate with handling agencies

Oral questions

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Maintain contacts with handling agents D2.TTG.CL3.12
Instructions	1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary 2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC') 3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
1. Names five types of organisations which use the services of handling agents.	☐	☐
2. Using the businesses identified in your answer to the previous question identify the general services provided by handling agents to these organisations.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
3. With reference to your personal experience of working with handling agents explain/illustrate the benefits to a business of using handling agents.	☐	☐
4. Use a specific industry example to identify key contact personnel within the business providing handling agency services.	☐	☐
5. Explain how you can identify/determine the contact details for a handling agent.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
6. Explain how you would determine the time difference between your country/geographic location and a handling agent in Melbourne, Australia?	☐	☐
7. Name a foreign country and explain to me how you would identify the holiday periods for the year in question for the country.	☐	☐
8. How would you determine the preferred protocols for contacting a handling agent?	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
9. Nominate one handling agent and describe the full list of services they provide.	☐	☐
10. Demonstrate an enquiry you may make with a handling agent in relation to a package.	☐	☐
11. Demonstrate an enquiry you may make with a handling agent in relation to local conditions.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
12. Give an example of the contact you have had with a handling agent in relation to following-up on a customer issue.	☐	☐
13. Give an example of 'existing arrangements' you have needed to update with a handling agent.	☐	☐
14. Describe how you advise and confirm travel arrangements with a handling agent.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
15. Nominate two handling agents you have dealt with and identify examples of the specialist advice you have obtained from them.	☐	☐
16. Describe how you record evidence of the service received from handling agents.	☐	☐
17. Give an example of when, why and how you have sought feedback from a handling agent.	☐	☐

Questions	Response	
	PC	NYC
18. How do you give management feedback about the service provided to you by handling agents you deal with?	☐	☐
19. Give me an example of action you have recommended to improve the relationship with handling agents.	☐	☐

Written questions

Maintain contacts with handling agents – D2.TTG.CL3.12

Student Name: _____

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. Explain in your own words the role of a handling agent.

2. By what other name may a handling agent be known?

3. List two types of organisations who use the services of a handling agent.

4. The general service provided by a handling agent can be split into two main categories. What are they?

5. Why is language expertise one of the benefits of using a handling agent?

6. List two ways you can identify key contact personnel.

7. What contact details do you need from a handling agent to conduct business?

8. How can you determine the time difference between a host enterprise country and the location of the handling agent?

9. List two types of recognised holidays all over the world.

10. What protocols must you identify in order to contact a handling agent?

11. What information do you required to create a comprehensive list of services available from the handling agent?

12. What is the main reason would you seek alternatives to existing packages.

13. List three conditions you need to check in regards to local conditions and the life of a package.

14. Give a couple of examples of last minute changes about which you might need to inform the handling agent.

15. When would updating arrangements take place?

16. Give two examples of travel details you need to reconfirm with the handling agent.

17. Why might you seek specialist advice in regards to in country laws and customs from the handling agent?

18. What type of evidence needs recording in regards to services received from a handling agent? List at least two.

19. How can seeking feedback from the handling agent improve the relationship between the two parties?

20. Explain why feedback must be contextualised.

21. List the three main categories recommended for your attention with regard to your relationship with handling agents

Answers to written questions

Maintain contacts with handling agents – D2.TTG.CL3.12

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

1. Explain in your own words the role of a handling agent.

A handling agent provides local destination knowledge and services. It act as an extension of the host it represents.

2. By what other name may a handling agent be known?

Destination Management Company (DMC).

3. List two types of organisations who use the services of a handling agent.

- Carrier companies
- Travel agencies
- Tour operators
- Accommodation companies.

4. The general service provided by a handling agent can be split into two main categories. Which one are they?

- Customer management
- Support services management.

5. Why is language expertise one of the benefits of using a handling agent?

To ensure clear communication in the host country with local authorities and businesses.

6. List two ways you can identify key contact personnel.

- By obtaining key contact details from handling agent
- By visiting the agency in person.

7. What contact details do you need from a handling agent to conduct business?

- Business address
- All telephone numbers.

8. How can you determine the time difference between a host enterprise country and the location of the handling agent?

Consult relevant internet sites or pre prepared up to date document.

9. List two types of recognised holidays all over the world.

- Religious festivals
- Gazetted public holidays.

10. What protocols must you identify in order to contact a handling agent?

- Which staff member is responsible for which area
- Preferred method of contact, preferred contact times.

11. What information do you need to create a comprehensive list of services available from the handling agent?

- Website address
- All contact names and details for staff members
- List of all services: transport, accommodation, package.

12. What is the main reason you would seek alternatives to existing packages.

Following consistent negative feedback from customers.

13. List three conditions you need to check in regards to local conditions and the life of a package.

- Weather
- Geographical layout
- Trading hours
- Schedules and timetables
- Local requirements
- Procedural and processing matters
- General service and products availability.

14. Give a couple of examples of last minute changes about which you need to inform the handling agent.

- Change of arrival details
- Emergency situation: passenger illness or replacement
- Legal issues such as visa requirements, theft of passport.

15. When would updating arrangements take place?

- Changes to individual customer travel arrangement
- Generic changes such as revisions of inclusions and options, new times, costs, destinations
- Advice sought in regards to proposed changes.

16. Give two examples of travel details you need to reconfirm with the handling agent.

- Arrival, departure details
- Special requests
- Number of passengers.

17. Why might you seek specialist advice in regards to in country laws and customs from the handling agent?

Because the handling agent has an in depth local knowledge and understanding of the laws and customs.

18. What type of evidence needs recording in regards to services received from a handling agent? List at least two

- Speed of response
- Quality of information and service received
- Level of service and assistance provided.

19. How can seeking feedback from the handling agent improve the relationship between the two parties?

Feedback will reveal what is working and what is not working and needs improvement.

20. Explain why feedback must be contextualised

So that it reflect the accurate situation in regards to the local environment and framework.

21. List the three main categories recommended for your attention with regard to your relationship with handling agents

- Communication improvement
 - Contract revision
 - Changing of handling agent.
-

Observation checklist

Student name	
Assessor name	
Location/venue	
Unit of competency	Maintain contacts with handling agents D2.TTG.CL3.12
Dates of observation	
Instructions	- Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks: - Define the role of the handling agent - Describe the contact and operational protocols between the business and the handling agent - Describe situations where contact with handling agents may be required Insert element - Evaluate the relationship with handling agents - Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken - Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise - Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Element 1: Define the role of the handling agent		
Identify the organisations who use the services of handling agents	☐	☐
Identify the general services provided by handling agents	☐	☐
Identify the benefits of using handling agents	☐	☐
Element 2: Describe the contact and operational protocols between the business and the handling agent		
Identify key contact personnel within the business providing handling agency services	☐	☐
Identify contact details	☐	☐
Determine the time difference between the host enterprise country and the location of the handling agent	☐	☐

Did the candidate	Yes	No
Identify the recognised holiday periods for the year in question for the country where the handling agent is situated	☐	☐
Identify the preferred protocols for contacting the handling agents	☐	☐
Create comprehensive list of services available from the handling agent	☐	☐
Element 3: Describe situations where contact with handling agents may be required		
Enquire about options for packages	☐	☐
Enquire about local conditions	☐	☐
Follow-up on customer issues	☐	☐
Update existing arrangements	☐	☐
Advise and confirm travel arrangements	☐	☐
Obtain specialist advice	☐	☐
Element 4: Evaluate the relationship with handling agents		
Record evidence of the service received from handling agents	☐	☐
Seek feedback from handling agents	☐	☐
Provide feedback to management regarding the service received	☐	☐
Recommend action to improve the relationship with handling agents	☐	☐
Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?	☐	☐

Feedback to student and trainer/assessor**Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**

Third Party Statement

Student name:			
Name of third party:		Contact no:	
Relationship to student:	☐ Employer ☐ Supervisor ☐ Colleague ☐ Other Please specify: _____ <i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i>		
Unit of competency:	Maintain contacts with handling agents D2.TTG.CL3.12		
The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence. Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you. Thank you for your time.			
Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills? <i>(tick the correct response]</i>	Yes	No	Not sure
Identifies handling agents used by the organisation, the services they provide and the benefits of using them	☐	☐	☐
Identifies key personnel within, contact details of and preferred contact methods for handling agents	☐	☐	☐
Determines relative times and applicable holidays in host countries of handling agents	☐	☐	☐
Contacts handling agents to obtain required operational information, follow-up customer issues, update arrangements, advise and confirm travel and obtain specialist advice	☐	☐	☐
Records evidence of the service received from handling agents	☐	☐	☐
Seeks feedback from handling agents	☐	☐	☐
Provides feedback to management regarding the service received	☐	☐	☐
Recommends action to improve the relationship with handling agents	☐	☐	☐

Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:

Third party signature:

Date:

Send to:

Competency recording sheet

Name of Student		
Name of Assessor/s		
Unit of Competency	Maintain contacts with handling agents	D2.TTG.CL3.12
Date assessment commenced		
Date assessment finalised		
Assessment decision	Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one)	
Follow up action required (Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency)		
Comments/observations by assessor/s		

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Element 1: Define the role of the handling agent						
Identify the organisations who use the services of handling agents						
Identify the general services provided by handling agents						
Identify the benefits of using handling agents						
Element 2: Describe the contact and operational protocols between the business and the handling agent						
Identify key contact personnel within the business providing handling agency services						
Identify contact details						
Determine the time difference between the host enterprise country and the location of the handling agent						
Identify the recognised holiday periods for the year in question for the country where the handling agent is situated						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria	Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Identify the preferred protocols for contacting the handling agents						
Create comprehensive list of services available from the handling agent						
Element 3: Describe situations where contact with handling agents may be required						
Enquire about options for packages						
Enquire about local conditions						
Follow-up on customer issues						
Update existing arrangements						
Advise and confirm travel arrangements						
Obtain specialist advice						
Element 4: Evaluate the relationship with handling agents						
Record evidence of the service received from handling agents						
Seek feedback from handling agents						

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

Element & Performance Criteria		Observation of skills	3rd Party Statement	Oral Questions	Written Questions	Work Projects	Other
Provide feedback to management regarding the service received							
Recommend action to improve the relationship with handling agents							
Candidate signature:				Date:			
Assessor signature:				Date:			

